SELF BEACON

THE 30-DAY BURNOUT RESET

ARCHETYPE

The Pressure Cooker

All four dimensions elevated. This is deep, sustained burnout.

A prescription, not a journal. Open it. Follow it. 30 days built specifically for your burnout pattern.

selfbeacon.com

YOUR PROFILE

YOUR PATTERN

All four burnout dimensions showing high simultaneously — physical depletion, emotional exhaustion, chronic overwhelm, and lost purpose. This is not one thing that went wrong but a sustained convergence. The system is under pressure from every direction at once.

Your emotional signature

Functions under extreme pressure with impressive competence. Has been operating in crisis mode for so long it feels normal. Cannot remember the last time they felt genuinely okay — not performing okay, actually okay. The whole system is strained.

TRIGGER

Any additional demand when already at absolute capacity · The realisation that this level of pressure has become the baseline · Being unable to identify a single area that feels okay · The physical, emotional, purposive, and workload alarms sounding simultaneously

RESPONSE

Keep functioning at a high level out of fear of what happens if you stop · Compartmentalise aggressively — deal with one crisis at a time · Perform stability while privately overwhelmed · Make plans to fix everything and then be too exhausted to act on them

ACTION

Add more structure in hope that control will reduce the pressure · Remove anything optional — including things that actually help · Cycle between hyperproductivity and complete collapse · Seek relief through anything that provides temporary numbing

COST

Physical symptoms across multiple body systems · Emotional exhaustion that affects close relationships · Complete loss of sense of what you actually want · The inability to imagine a version of life that feels sustainable

Your 4-week arc

Week 1 — Stabilize	Safety first. One thing at a time. Stop the bleeding before the repair.
Week 2 — Triage	Which dimension needs the most relief right now? Work on one.
Week 3 — Ground	One practice, consistently, for two weeks. Nothing else.

Week 4 — Breathe	One area improving. Build from that single foothold.

EMERGENCY REFERENCE — PHOTOGRAPH OR CUT OUT THIS PAGE

WHEN YOU SPIRAL

3-step protocol for each acute moment. Use it — do not think about it.

OVERWHELM

Heart racing. Too much at once. Cannot prioritise.

1. **Ground your body**
   Both feet flat on the floor. Full exhale — longer out than in. Say: I am here, I am safe right now.
2. **Name one thing only**
   Not the list. One thing. The single most pressing item. Write it. Everything else is later.
3. **Two minutes then decide**
   Work only on that one thing for two minutes. After two minutes: stop or continue.

SHUTDOWN

Numb, detached, going through the motions.

1. **Name it out loud**
   Say or write: I am in shutdown. My system is protecting me. It is temporary. I am not broken.
2. **One physical action**
   Cold water on wrists. Stand and stretch arms wide. Walk to a window. Body re-engages through movement.
3. **5-4-3-2-1 grounding**
   5 things you see. 4 you can touch. 3 you hear. 2 you smell. 1 you taste. Returns attention to the present.

ANXIETY SPIKE

Sudden panic. Chest tight. Catastrophic thoughts starting.

1. **4-7-8 breath**
   In through nose for 4. Hold for 7. Out through mouth for 8. Three cycles. Activates parasympathetic response.
2. **Question the catastrophe**
   Ask: is this happening right now, or am I predicting? Anxiety lives in the future. You live here.
3. **Reduce the scope**
   What is one thing you can do or decide in the next 10 minutes? Do only that.

WEEK 1

STABILIZE

Safety first. One thing at a time. Stop the bleeding before the repair..

DAILY SCHEDULE

TIME	PRACTICE	WHAT TO DO
6:30 AM	**4-7-8 breath**	3 rounds. This is the only required practice in week 1. Everything else is optional.
6:35 AM	**One thing**	What is the single most important thing for today? Write it. Only this.
6:38 AM	**Stabilise check**	What is actively making things worse right now? Name one thing to stop doing today.
12:00 PM	**5-min rest**	Close eyes. No phone. 5 minutes. This is medicine. Not optional.
12:05 PM	**Triage**	What still needs to happen today? What can wait? Cross one thing off the list that is not actually urgent.
9:00 PM	**4-7-8 breath**	3 rounds before sleep. The bookend to the morning. Same practice, same commitment.
9:05 PM	**One win**	Name one thing that was slightly better today than yesterday. Even tiny. This is evidence the trend can change.
9:07 PM	**Tomorrow's one thing**	Write it now. Reduces the cognitive load of tomorrow morning.

WEEK 1 FOCUS

Safety first. One thing at a time. Stop the bleeding before the repair.. The pressure cooker has been running at maximum for too long. The work is not optimisation — it is pressure reduction. Every degree of relief is meaningful. Stabilise before you improve.

WEEK 1 TRACKER

MARK AM + PM EACH DAY

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
AM	AM	AM	AM	AM	AM	AM
PM	PM	PM	PM	PM	PM	PM

END OF WEEK 1

What showed up most this week?

Which practice felt most useful?

What do I carry into next week?

WEEK 2

TRIAGE

Which dimension needs the most relief right now? Work on one..

DAILY SCHEDULE

TIME	PRACTICE	WHAT TO DO
6:30 AM	**4-7-8 breath**	3 rounds. This is the only required practice in week 1. Everything else is optional.
6:35 AM	**One thing**	What is the single most important thing for today? Write it. Only this.
6:38 AM	**Stabilise check**	What is actively making things worse right now? Name one thing to stop doing today.
12:00 PM	**5-min rest**	Close eyes. No phone. 5 minutes. This is medicine. Not optional.
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9:00 PM	**4-7-8 breath**	3 rounds before sleep. The bookend to the morning. Same practice, same commitment.
9:05 PM	**One win**	Name one thing that was slightly better today than yesterday. Even tiny. This is evidence the trend can change.
9:07 PM	**Tomorrow's one thing**	Write it now. Reduces the cognitive load of tomorrow morning.

WEEK 2 FOCUS

Which dimension needs the most relief right now? Work on one.. The pressure cooker has been running at maximum for too long. The work is not optimisation — it is pressure reduction. Every degree of relief is meaningful. Stabilise before you improve.

WEEK 2 TRACKER

MARK AM + PM EACH DAY

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
AM ☐	AM ☐	AM ☐	AM ☐	AM ☐	AM ☐	AM ☐
PM ☐	PM ☐	PM ☐	PM ☐	PM ☐	PM ☐	PM ☐

END OF WEEK 2

What showed up most this week?

Which practice felt most useful?

What do I carry into next week?

WEEK 3

GROUND

One practice, consistently, for two weeks. Nothing else..

DAILY SCHEDULE

TIME	PRACTICE	WHAT TO DO
6:30 AM	**4-7-8 breath**	3 rounds. This is the only required practice in week 1. Everything else is optional.
6:35 AM	**One thing**	What is the single most important thing for today? Write it. Only this.
6:38 AM	**Stabilise check**	What is actively making things worse right now? Name one thing to stop doing today.
12:00 PM	**5-min rest**	Close eyes. No phone. 5 minutes. This is medicine. Not optional.
12:05 PM	**Triage**	What still needs to happen today? What can wait? Cross one thing off the list that is not actually urgent.
9:00 PM	**4-7-8 breath**	3 rounds before sleep. The bookend to the morning. Same practice, same commitment.
9:05 PM	**One win**	Name one thing that was slightly better today than yesterday. Even tiny. This is evidence the trend can change.
9:07 PM	**Tomorrow's one thing**	Write it now. Reduces the cognitive load of tomorrow morning.

WEEK 3 FOCUS

One practice, consistently, for two weeks. Nothing else.. The pressure cooker has been running at maximum for too long. The work is not optimisation — it is pressure reduction. Every degree of relief is meaningful. Stabilise before you improve.

WEEK 3 TRACKER

MARK AM + PM EACH DAY

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
AM	AM	AM	AM	AM	AM	AM
PM	PM	PM	PM	PM	PM	PM

END OF WEEK 3

What showed up most this week?

Which practice felt most useful?

What do I carry into next week?

WEEK 4

BREATHE

One area improving. Build from that single foothold..

DAILY SCHEDULE

TIME	PRACTICE	WHAT TO DO
6:30 AM	**4-7-8 breath**	3 rounds. This is the only required practice in week 1. Everything else is optional.
6:35 AM	**One thing**	What is the single most important thing for today? Write it. Only this.
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9:05 PM	**One win**	Name one thing that was slightly better today than yesterday. Even tiny. This is evidence the trend can change.
9:07 PM	**Tomorrow's one thing**	Write it now. Reduces the cognitive load of tomorrow morning.

WEEK 4 FOCUS

One area improving. Build from that single foothold.. The pressure cooker has been running at maximum for too long. The work is not optimisation — it is pressure reduction. Every degree of relief is meaningful. Stabilise before you improve.

WEEK 4 TRACKER

MARK AM + PM EACH DAY

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
AM	AM	AM	AM	AM	AM	AM
PM	PM	PM	PM	PM	PM	PM

END OF WEEK 4

What showed up most this week?

Which practice felt most useful?

What do I carry into next week?

TECHNIQUE LIBRARY

HOW THE TOOLS WORK

Six techniques matched to The Pressure Cooker. Exact steps.

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01 — STABILIZE FIRST

Nothing gets built on an unstable foundation. Week 1 is only about stopping what is actively making things worse. Not improving — stopping the damage.

02 — ONE THING AT A TIME

The pressure cooker tries to fix everything simultaneously. This makes everything worse. Pick the single most acute dimension. Work only on that. The others wait.

03 — BREATH ANCHORS

4-7-8 three times in the morning. 4-7-8 three times before bed. These are the only non-negotiable practices for week 1. Everything else is optional.

04 — 5-MINUTE REST

Not 20 minutes. Not a nap. 5 minutes of complete stillness. Three times a day. Tiny doses of genuine rest compound faster than you expect.

05 — MICRO-BOUNDARIES

Start impossibly small. One boundary per day. Not a confrontation — a decision. "I will not check email after 9pm tonight." That is it for today.

06 — DAILY TRIAGE

Each morning: what is the single most pressing thing I can actually address today? Everything else is tomorrow's problem. One thing. Real triage.

YOUR PATTERN CARD — READ AT THE START OF EACH WEEK

THE LOOP
& THE INTERRUPT

TRIGGER

Any additional demand when already at absolute capacity · The realisation that this level of pressure has become the baseline · Being unable to identify a single area that feels okay · The physical, emotional, purposive, and workload alarms sounding simultaneously

Interrupt: These activate something real. That does not make them emergencies. Notice the activation without acting on it.

RESPONSE

Keep functioning at a high level out of fear of what happens if you stop · Compartmentalise aggressively — deal with one crisis at a time · Perform stability while privately overwhelmed · Make plans to fix everything and then be too exhausted to act on them

Interrupt: Protective responses, not character flaws. Slow them by 3 seconds. That is all that is needed.

ACTION

Add more structure in hope that control will reduce the pressure · Remove anything optional — including things that actually help · Cycle between hyperproductivity and complete collapse · Seek relief through anything that provides temporary numbing

Interrupt: Looking for relief. Ask: does this give relief, or silence while the real thing grows? Rest without disappearing.

COST

Physical symptoms across multiple body systems · Emotional exhaustion that affects close relationships · Complete loss of sense of what you actually want · The inability to imagine a version of life that feels sustainable

Interrupt: Each 3-second pause at step 2 reduces the cost at step 4. Small interruptions, compounded over a month, produce real change.

YOU ARE NOT BROKEN.

YOU CAUGHT IT.

THAT TOOK HONESTY.

Use this on the hard days. Especially the hard days.